



YOUTUBE PRODUCTION BIBLE

The Complete Master Reference — Every Framework, System, and Tip

Kallaway · Paddy Galloway · Aprilynne Alter · VidIQ · MrBeast · DaVinci Resolve Organic Storytelling System · 8 Template
Packages · Packaging · Checklists

Built for Kaeden's Gaming Channel — Roblox, Horror, Simulators, Fortnite, Apex & More
Compiled from all previous PDF sessions — one file to rule them all

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The Universal Rule

What every top creator agrees on

THE GOLDEN RULE OF YOUTUBE

Idea → Packaging → Content. In that order. Most creators spend 80% of their time on production (recording/editing) and almost nothing on ideas and packaging. But packaging is what gets the click, and the idea is what makes the video worth watching. Content quality only matters if people actually click first.

Stage	What It Is	How Much Time?	What It Affects
IDEA	The concept, the angle, the reason this video exists	~20%	Everything downstream
PACKAGING	Title + Thumbnail + Hook — why someone clicks	~30%	CTR (Click-Through Rate)
CONTENT	The actual gameplay and edit quality	~50%	AVD (Avg View Duration)

The Brutal Math

A great video with bad packaging = 0 views. A mediocre video with great packaging = viral potential. This isn't about gaming the algorithm — it's about respecting the viewer's attention. They have thousands of videos to choose from. Your packaging is your handshake.

Section 2: The Meta-Lesson

WHAT EVERY TOP CREATOR AGREES ON

You don't lose because your recording quality is bad. You lose because your title is forgettable, your thumbnail is unclear, and your hook doesn't create a reason to stay. The RTX 5070, the SteelSeries headset, the dual-PC setup — none of it moves the needle as much as a sharper title and a stronger thumbnail. Packaging deserves as much time as editing.

Creator	Their #1 Lesson
Kallaway	Most creators lose in packaging, not production
Paddy Galloway	Write the title and sketch the thumbnail BEFORE recording
Aprilynne Alter	Content is the 3rd thing — idea and packaging come first
MrBeast	CTR is your report card — if it's low, fix the packaging
VidIQ	Find what people are already searching for, then make that video

Idea Generation

Where good video ideas come from — and how to know when one is ready

The Core Problem With Idea Generation

The reason ideas don't feel exciting or 'good enough' usually comes down to one of three things:

PROBLEM 1 — The idea is too vague

"I'll play Doors" is not a video idea — it's a session.

"I'll beat Doors without ever running from an entity" is a video idea.

Specificity is what turns a gaming session into a concept worth filming.

PROBLEM 2 — The idea doesn't have a story yet

A video idea only becomes real when you can answer: what is at stake, and what happens at the end?

If you can't answer that, you don't have an idea — you have a starting point.

Ask: what is the resolution? Win, fail, discovery, or surprise — pick one.

PROBLEM 3 — It's a stream idea, not a YouTube idea

A stream is "hang out with me while I play X."

A YouTube video is "a specific thing is going to happen — watch to find out what."

The framing is completely different even if the gameplay is identical.

THE ONE TEST THAT CUTS THROUGH OVERTHINKING

"Would I click this if someone else posted it?" That's it. If the honest answer is yes, the idea is ready. If it's "maybe" or "I guess," the idea needs a sharper angle. You're not asking if it's the best video ever made — you just need to believe a real person would genuinely click it.

Where Ideas Actually Come From

1

Your Own Streams (Reactive Ideation)

After every stream, ask: what was the single funniest or most surprising thing that happened? Was there a moment where you genuinely didn't know what was going to happen? Did something go unexpectedly wrong — or right? Did chat go crazy at a specific moment? That moment IS the idea. The video is built backwards from it.

2

Questions You Had Going In

Before playing a new game, write down every question you have about it. 'Can you actually beat this without upgrades?' 'Is this game actually scary or is everyone overreacting?' Those questions are video ideas with packaging already built in — the title is literally just the question.

3

The What If Method

Take any game you play and finish: 'What if I played this but...' — I could only use one item / I had to finish in 20 minutes / me and my friend swapped controllers every 5 minutes / I played the first 10 minutes with my eyes closed. The restriction creates the story. You don't invent drama — you engineer the situation that generates it.

4

YouTube Search Autocomplete

Type your game name into YouTube search and write down every autocomplete suggestion. Each one is a real search from a real person who wanted to watch that content. If someone is searching for it, the demand already exists — make that video.

5

Your Genuine Emotional Reaction

If a game made you feel something strongly — scared, frustrated, impressed, confused — that emotion IS the video. 'This game made me feel genuinely claustrophobic' is a better premise than 'let me show you this cool game.' Strong feelings are always clickable.

The Excitement Check — Before You Commit

An idea is ready when you can answer YES to all three of these:

Question	What a YES Looks Like
Can I write a title that makes ME want to click it?	You feel a small spike of excitement just reading it
Do I know what the thumbnail will roughly show?	You can describe the image in one sentence
Do I know what 'the end' looks like?	There's a resolution — win, fail, discovery, or payoff

IF YOU CAN'T GET 3 YESES — DON'T ABANDON THE IDEA

Sharpen the angle until you can. 'I'll play Doors' → 'I'll play Doors for the first time blind' → 'I'll play Doors blind with a 30-minute time limit or I delete the game.' Each step gets closer to 3 yeses. The original instinct was right — it just needed sharpening.

10 Video Idea Templates With Built-In Packaging

These are game-agnostic formulas. Every one gives you the concept, the title pattern, the thumbnail direction, a Shorts potential rating, AND a set of signals to tell you whether footage you already have fits this template — so you can work backwards from clips too.

Template A — The Impossible Challenge

CONCEPT	Play the game with a specific restriction that makes success genuinely hard.
TITLE FORMULA	"I Tried to Beat [Game] Using Only [X]" / "I Beat [Game] With One Rule — [Rule]"
THUMBNAIL	Your frustrated or determined face + the restricted item or the impossible situation
WHY IT WORKS	The restriction IS the hook. Viewers are instantly rooting for or against you — and curious whether it's even possible.
EXAMPLE	<i>"I Tried to Beat Doors Using Only My Flashlight (No Running Allowed)"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■■ HIGH — The restriction = instant Shorts premise. Clip the moment the rule nearly breaks you.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage where you arbitrarily limited yourself, used a bad strategy on purpose, or refused to use a mechanic. If the clip shows you struggling because of a self-imposed rule → Template A.

Template B — The First Timer

CONCEPT	Play something completely blind for the first time. Zero preparation, zero research — genuine ignorance on camera.
TITLE FORMULA	"I Played [Game] For the First Time and [What Happened]" / "I Was NOT Ready For [Game]"
THUMBNAIL	Your confused or shocked face + a game element that looks alarming with no context needed
WHY IT WORKS	Genuine ignorance = genuine reactions. You cannot fake not knowing something. First-time energy is one of the most watchable things on YouTube.
EXAMPLE	<i>"I Played Pressure For the First Time and I Was NOT Prepared For Any of This"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■■■ VERY HIGH — Every jump scare, every first death, every 'what IS that' moment is a standalone Short.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have stream footage of a game you'd never played before. If you can find the moment you first encountered the game's main mechanic or scare — that's your Short. The whole session = Template B.

Template C — The Rematch

CONCEPT	A game or challenge previously destroyed you. You went back. This is the return.
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TITLE FORMULA	"[Game] Beat Me Last Time. Not Today." / "I Finally Beat [Game] After [X Attempts]"
THUMBNAIL	Determined expression + the enemy, boss, or challenge that beat you last time
WHY IT WORKS	Built-in backstory. Built-in stakes. Viewers want redemption arcs — it's one of the oldest and most reliable story structures that exists.
EXAMPLE	<i>"Backrooms Rec. Ended Me Last Week. I Came Back With a Plan."</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■ MEDIUM — The winning moment itself is a perfect Short — but only lands if viewers know the backstory. Link to the original video in the Short's caption.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage where you finally beat something after failing it before — even if the first failure was on a previous stream. If there's a payoff moment where you visibly react to finally winning → Template C.

Template D — The Time Limit

CONCEPT	Accomplish a specific goal before a self-imposed deadline. The clock is the entire source of tension.
TITLE FORMULA	"I Had [X Minutes] to [Accomplish Y] in [Game]" / "Beat [Game] Before the Timer Hits Zero or [Consequence]"
THUMBNAIL	A timer visible or strongly implied in the image + your stressed or panicked reaction
WHY IT WORKS	Artificial urgency creates real tension. Every second of footage has stakes attached because the clock is always running in the background of the viewer's head.
EXAMPLE	<i>"I Had 30 Minutes to Max Out Pet Simulator or I Delete My Account"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■■ HIGH — The final 60 seconds before the deadline = instant Short. Pure tension, zero context needed.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage where you were racing toward a goal with a natural or self-imposed deadline. If the clip has visible urgency and a clear success/fail outcome → Template D.

Template E — The Worst Strategy

CONCEPT	Play using the most inefficient, backwards, or wrong approach possible — on purpose.
TITLE FORMULA	"I Beat [Game] Using the Worst Strategy" / "What Happens If You [Do the Wrong Thing] in [Game]"
THUMBNAIL	The obviously wrong or chaotic game moment + your reaction to how badly (or surprisingly well) it's going
WHY IT WORKS	Schadenfreude and curiosity in one package. Viewers want to watch it fail AND are weirdly impressed if it somehow works. Both outcomes are satisfying.
EXAMPLE	<i>"What Happens If You Never Buy Upgrades in a Simulator Game (I Found Out)"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■ MEDIUM — The moment the bad strategy either spectacularly fails or shockingly works = perfect Short.

ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage where you or a friend did something obviously wrong, picked the bad option, or ignored the correct strategy. If the clip shows a clearly suboptimal choice with a reaction → Template E.
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Template F — The Co-op Disaster

CONCEPT	You and a friend attempt something that genuinely requires coordination. It doesn't go well.
TITLE FORMULA	"We Tried to [Accomplish X] Together and [What Went Wrong]" / "He Should NOT Be Allowed to [Do X]"
THUMBNAIL	Both of your faces — ideally one panicking and one in the middle of doing something wrong
WHY IT WORKS	Two reactions, two personalities, one disaster. More emotional information = more reasons for different viewers to click.
EXAMPLE	<i>"We Tried to Run a Supermarket Together. We Got Fired on Day One."</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■■■ VERY HIGH — Friend fails are the most clippable content on the internet. Every major mess-up = a Short with zero editing needed beyond a crop.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have co-op footage where something went catastrophically wrong because of one person's decision. If the clip has a clear cause (friend's mistake) and effect (disaster) with both of your reactions → Template F.

Template G — The Investigation

CONCEPT	Something weird, broken, or unexplained in a game. You need to find out what it is.
TITLE FORMULA	"Something Weird Is Happening in [Game]" / "I Found Something in [Game] That Shouldn't Exist"
THUMBNAIL	The weird or unexplained game element + your genuinely confused expression
WHY IT WORKS	Curiosity gap is massive. Viewers feel like they're solving a mystery alongside you — which is one of the hardest feelings to click away from.
EXAMPLE	<i>"There's a Room in This Roblox Game That Doesn't Show Up on the Map"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■ MEDIUM — The discovery moment itself clips well — but the Short works best as a teaser, not a resolution. Leave viewers wanting to watch the full video for the answer.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage where something unexpected, glitchy, or out-of-place happened in the game. If the clip shows a moment of genuine confusion or discovery — especially if the explanation takes longer than 60 seconds → Template G.

Template H — The Social Experiment

CONCEPT	Do something unusual in a multiplayer game and document how other players react.
TITLE FORMULA	"I Tried Being [Unexpectedly Nice/Chaotic/Helpful] in [Game] and This Happened"

THUMBNAIL	Other players' visible reactions + your expression watching it unfold
WHY IT WORKS	Unpredictable outcomes from real people. The other players ARE the content — you're the catalyst. Viewers stay to see how strangers react.
EXAMPLE	<i>"I Tried Helping Every New Player in Doors and It Got Really Weird"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■ MEDIUM — Pick the funniest single interaction — other player's reaction + your reaction = complete Short.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have multiplayer footage where other players reacted to something you did in an interesting or funny way. If the clip shows a clear action-reaction dynamic between you and a stranger → Template H.

Template I — The Rating Run

CONCEPT	Play through multiple versions of something in a game and rank them by your own criteria.
TITLE FORMULA	"Every [Item/Level/Boss/Game] in [Game] Ranked Worst to Best" / "I Rated Every [X] So You Don't Have To"
THUMBNAIL	A tier list visual OR your reaction to the absolute worst or best entry on the list
WHY IT WORKS	People who play the same game have strong opinions and will watch specifically to agree or argue. Opinion content drives comments — and comments drive the algorithm.
EXAMPLE	<i>"Every Roblox Horror Game I've Played Ranked (Some Are Actually Terrifying)"</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■ LOW-MEDIUM — Your strongest reaction to the worst or best item on the list = Short. Lead with the reaction, not the ranking context.
ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?	You have footage from multiple sessions of the same game, or you've played several games in the same genre. If you could describe your feelings about each one in one sentence → Template I.

Template J — The Challenge Bet

CONCEPT	You or your friend faces a personal consequence if you fail. Stakes are real, not just in-game.
TITLE FORMULA	"If I Lose This, [Personal Consequence]" / "Me and [Friend] Bet [X] on [Game] — This Is What Happened"
THUMBNAIL	Both faces + a visual hint at the personal stakes (not just game stakes)
WHY IT WORKS	Personal stakes are more compelling than game stakes alone. Viewers are invested in YOU losing or winning, not just the character on screen. They want to watch you squirm.
EXAMPLE	<i>"Me and Bill Bet On Who Could Survive Longer in This Horror Game. Loser Has to Stream It Alone at 3AM."</i>
SHORTS POTENTIAL	■■■■ HIGH — The moment the loser is determined = perfect Short. Pure reaction, immediate resolution.

ALREADY HAVE FOOTAGE?

You have co-op footage where there was a genuine rivalry, running joke about who's better, or any moment of 'loser does X.' If the footage has competitive energy and a clear winner and loser → Template J.

THE FOOTAGE → TEMPLATE LOOKUP (QUICK REFERENCE)

Already have clips and not sure where they fit? Solo + restriction/challenge = A, D, or E. Solo + first time playing = B. Solo + came back after a loss = C. Solo + found something weird = G. Solo + rating or opinion = I. Co-op + disaster/failure = F or J. Multiplayer + stranger reactions = H. ANY footage: if it made you laugh or react strongly in the moment — that's your Short. Don't overthink the template. The template is for planning. The footage is the truth.

Stream Moment → Video Idea Conversion

After every stream, write one moment in Notion Quick Capture using this format:

THE FORMAT

"[What happened] + [why it was interesting/funny/surprising]" | Then ask: can I build a full video around this moment, or is this just a clip? | If the moment is self-contained and hits in under 60 seconds → it's a Short. If the moment needs context to land → it's the PEAK of a longer video, and everything before it becomes the setup. The moment you're building toward already exists in your footage. Edit backwards from it.

Kallaway

@kallawaymarketing — Hook science, packaging systems, gaming growth

The 3-Step Hook Formula

Step 1 — Context Lean

Give the viewer just enough context to understand what they're about to see.

Don't over-explain. One sentence. Set the world.

Example: "So I decided to try something no one in this game has ever done."

Step 2 — Pattern Interrupt

Break the expected flow. Say or show something that stops the scroll.

This is the moment they think 'wait, what?' and commit to watching.

Example: "And halfway through, I realized the whole game is basically broken."

Step 3 — Contrarian Snapback

Flip the expectation. Challenge what the viewer assumes is true.

Creates curiosity and makes the video feel worth watching to the end.

Example: "But here's the thing — everyone who tried this quit too early."

The 5 Content Games

Every successful YouTube video plays at least one of these games. The best ones play 2-3 at once.

Content Game	What It Does	Gaming Example
Curiosity	Creates a question the viewer needs answered	"What happens if you never upgrade in this game?"
Transformation	Shows a journey from A to B	"I went from level 1 to max level in 24 hours"
Controversy	Takes a stance that invites reaction	"This game everyone loves is actually terrible"
Relatability	Makes the viewer feel seen	"When you finally beat the hard boss after 50 tries"
Inspiration	Motivates or impresses the viewer	"I 1v4'd an entire squad and somehow won"

Story Locks

A story lock is when your title and thumbnail tell the same story from different angles. The title creates curiosity, the thumbnail creates emotion. Neither repeats the other — they work together.

STORY LOCK EXAMPLE

Title: 'He Should NOT Be Allowed Near A Broom' | Thumbnail: Bill with a broom looking chaotic, your reaction face. The title creates the question (WHY not?), the thumbnail shows the answer emotionally (pure chaos). Together they guarantee the click.

Kallaway's Workflow Tips

1

Batch Film and Edit

Record 3-4 gaming sessions in one block, then edit all of them in one editing block. Way more efficient than the film → edit → film → edit cycle. Use your Mon/Wed/Fri/Sat streams as your raw footage library.

2

Every Long Video Should Produce Shorts

While editing, flag 3-5 moments that work as standalone 30-60 second clips. Funny reactions, big plays, shocking moments. Basically zero extra filming time.

3

Script Your First 30 Seconds Only

You don't need to script gameplay. But scripting your hook, setup, and re-hook lines tightens the video without making it feel unnatural or overly produced.

4

Fish Where the Fish Are

Before each video, type your game name into YouTube search and note the autocomplete suggestions. Make videos that answer those exact searches. This is consistent search traffic between uploads.

5

Outlier Research

Find the best-performing videos in your niche (same game, similar channels). Study what made them work — the title pattern, the thumbnail style, the hook. Then do your version of what already works.

Paddy Galloway

Consultant to MrBeast, Ryan Trahan, Jesser — 700M+ views/month from clients

The 0→100→10→1 Idea Funnel

The most important framework for avoiding mediocre video ideas. Don't run with your first idea — run with your best idea.

Stage	What You Do	Why
0 → 100	Generate 100 video ideas without filtering	Most ideas are bad — that's fine
100 → 10	Filter to 10 you're genuinely excited about	Excitement = energy on camera
10 → 1	Develop just 1 final video concept	All your creative energy in one video

WHY THIS MATTERS

MrBeast's team runs every video concept through a version of this process. Most creators run with idea #3 or #4. The best videos come from idea #70 or #85. The only way to find your best idea is to exhaust your average ones first.

The CCN Framework

Every video you make is watched by three types of people. Design your packaging and content for all three.

Viewer Type	Who They Are	What They Need
Core	Your loyal fans — they watch everything	Personality, in-jokes, callbacks
Casual	Have seen a video or two before	A clear reason to watch THIS one
New	Never heard of you	A self-contained video they can follow without context

The Glance Test

CAN SOMEONE UNDERSTAND YOUR THUMBNAIL IN UNDER 1 SECOND?

If you have to explain your thumbnail, it failed. Cover your title with your hand and look at the thumbnail alone — is it clear what's happening? Does it trigger emotion or curiosity? If not, simplify it. One face, one emotion, one visual context. That's it.

TAM Research (Total Addressable Market)

Before making a video, ask: how many people are searching for this? A great video on a topic nobody cares about will still get no views. Use YouTube search autocomplete and VidIQ to verify demand before investing time in a video.

→ Type the game name into YouTube search and note autocomplete suggestions

- Check how many views similar videos are getting (not just subscriber count)
- Make sure the search demand actually exists before starting production
- Pick topics where the TAM is bigger than your current audience — this is how you grow

Pre-Production Mindset Shift

WRITE THE TITLE BEFORE YOU RECORD

This is Paddy's biggest tip. If you can't write a clear, compelling title before you start, you don't have a video yet — you have a session. A title-first approach forces you to get clear on what the video is actually about. Sketch the thumbnail idea too. If both feel exciting, record the video. If they don't, rethink the concept.

Aprilynne Alter

Former Google/YouTube employee — audience psychology & video recipe systems

The 3 T's System

T1 — TOPIC (What it's about)

The actual subject matter of your video.

Is this a game people are searching for? Is there a clear concept beyond 'I played this game'?

If you can't explain the topic in one sentence, the concept isn't ready.

T2 — TITLE (How it's packaged)

The title is your packaging — it creates the reason to click.

A good title creates a gap between what the viewer knows and what they want to know.

Under 60 characters so it doesn't get cut off on mobile.

T3 — THUMBNAIL (The visual hook)

The thumbnail is your billboard. It sells the emotion, not the information.

One strong emotion on a face + one visual that sets the scene.

It works WITH the title, not against it. They should tell the same story from different angles.

The Video Recipe Framework

A 'recipe' is a repeatable video format that generates similar content with predictable results. Think: 'Bill Chaos videos', 'Horror game firsts', 'Simulator grind challenges'. Once you have a recipe that works, you don't start from scratch every time.

YOUR RECIPES IN ACTION

The 'Supermarket Together with Bill' format IS a recipe: two players, chaotic co-op, one of them (Bill) does something catastrophically wrong, your reaction IS the content. Once you identify the recipe, every video in that format is easier to plan, record, and edit.

Audience Psychology

Make Them Feel...

How to Do It

Seen (relatable)	Reference shared gamer experiences — rage quitting, getting carried, failing the same spot twice
Laughing (entertained)	Bill Chaos package, unexpected fails, your genuine reaction to something absurd
Impressed (inspired)	Big clutch moments, grinding to max level, beating something hard
Curious (hooked)	Set up a question in the title/hook that the video answers

Retention & Feedback

Read your retention graph in YouTube Studio after every video. The graph shows you exactly where people left. Use it as a feedback system, not a report card:

Retention Symptom	What It Means	What to Fix
Big drop in first 30 sec	Hook isn't delivering on the title/thumbnail promise	Rewrite the intro, match energy to packaging
Gradual decline throughout	Pacing issues — dead air or slow sections	Tighter edits, more re-engagement moments
Cliff drop at a specific point	Something specific caused the drop (ad, long section, tonal shift)	Identify and cut that type of moment in future videos
Flat and steady	Solid video — this is the goal	Replicate the structure

VidIQ

Data-driven YouTube strategy — keyword research, trending content, upload systems

Keyword Research Workflow

1

YouTube Autocomplete

Type your game name into YouTube search and note every autocomplete suggestion. These are real search queries from real viewers. Each one is a potential video idea with built-in demand.

2

Install VidIQ Extension

VidIQ shows you search volume and competition score on every search result. Look for topics with High Volume + Low Competition — that's the sweet spot for growing channels.

3

Check the 'Trending' Tab

Set up trending alerts for games you cover. When a game gets a patch or a viral moment, the window to get views is short — the creators who move fast win.

4

Analyze Successful Videos

Use VidIQ to see the tags and keywords successful videos in your niche are using. Don't copy — adapt. Use the same keyword themes in your own way.

Description Optimization

Most gaming creators write lazy descriptions ('watch me play this game lol'). A properly optimized description can get you extra algorithmic push:

- First sentence: include your main keyword naturally (game name + what the video is about)
- Second paragraph: expand on the video topic — this is what YouTube reads for context
- Add timestamps for longer videos (10+ mins) — improves watch time and UX
- Include relevant game name hashtags at the end (#Roblox, #FortniteClips, etc.)
- Link to your Twitch or other relevant videos in the description

Repeatable Upload Workflow

CONSISTENCY > FREQUENCY

VidIQ's data consistently shows that channels with a predictable upload schedule grow faster than channels that spam uploads irregularly. Pick a schedule you can actually keep — even 1 video/week at a consistent time beats 5 videos in one week and nothing for a month. Your audience learns to expect you.

AI-Assisted Ideation

Use VidIQ's AI tools (or Claude) to brainstorm title variations and thumbnail concepts before committing to one. The difference between a 2% CTR title and a 12% CTR title is often just 3-4 word swaps. Generate 10 title options, pick the best two, test them.

MrBeast's Production Bible

The most-studied creator on YouTube — retention, structure, metrics

The 3 Core Metrics

Metric	What It Is	Target	If It's Low...
CTR	Click-Through Rate — % who see thumbnail and click	8-12%+ for gaming	Packaging problem — fix title/thumbnail
AVD	Average View Duration — how long people watch on average	40-50%+ of total length	Hook or pacing problem
AVP	Average View Percentage — what % of the video people finish	40%+	Ending is too slow or video is too long

THE DIAGNOSTIC FORMULA

CTR low + AVD high = packaging problem (great video, nobody's clicking). Fix the title and thumbnail. | CTR high + AVD low = hook/intro problem (people click but leave early). Fix the first 60 seconds. | Both low = concept problem. Start with a better idea.

The First-Minute Rule

MrBeast has said the first 60 seconds of a video is the most important production decision you'll make. If someone watches the first minute, they're very likely to watch 50%+ of the total video. This is why your hook, your premise setup, and your energy in the intro matter more than any other part of the edit.

The Hero Clip First Principle

SHOW YOUR BEST MOMENT EARLY

Don't 'save' your best moment for the end. MrBeast puts his most impressive or interesting moment in the first 30-60 seconds, THEN tells the story of how he got there. Viewers need to know the payoff is worth staying for — show them early.

Re-Engagement Every 3 Minutes

For every 3 minutes of video, you need at least one re-engagement beat. This can be:

- A new question or challenge introduced (raises stakes)
- A callback to something earlier (rewards loyal viewers)
- A tonal shift — go from high energy to quiet or vice versa
- A surprising reveal or unexpected outcome

→ A direct address to the viewer ('okay this is where it gets crazy')

The 100 Iterations Mindset

EVERY VIDEO IS A DATA POINT, NOT A REPORT CARD

MrBeast's underlying philosophy is that every video teaches you something. A video with low CTR teaches you packaging. A video with bad retention teaches you pacing. A video that went viral teaches you a formula to repeat. Stop treating individual videos as pass/fail — treat them as iterations in an ongoing experiment. Your 30th video will be dramatically better than your 5th, but only if you keep going.

The 8 Template Packages

Organic Storytelling — loose scripted intro + improv gameplay + story found in edit

What Organic Storytelling Actually Is

THE STRUCTURE YOU'RE NATURALLY DOING

Scripted Setup (intro) → Loose Premise → Gameplay Creates the Story → You React In the Moment → Editing Shapes It Into a Narrative. The script isn't the story — the edit is. You're basically a filmmaker who improvises the footage and finds the story in post.

All 8 Packages

Pick one before every recording session. Takes 30 seconds.

■ Package 1

The Mission

Best for: When you have a clear specific goal to accomplish

Premise:

I'm trying to accomplish X in Y game before something stops me

Sample intro line:

"I've been putting this off for too long. Today we actually do it."

■ Package 2

Bill Chaos

Best for: Any co-op or duo session with Bill

Premise:

Me and Bill are going to try X and Bill is going to be the reason it fails

Sample intro line:

"Me and Bill are doing this today. One of us is not going to survive."

■ Package 3

The Discovery

Best for: Exploring a new game blind for the first time

Premise:

I know nothing about this game and I'm going to find out what it is live

Sample intro line:

"I know absolutely nothing about this game. Let's change that right now."

■ Package 4

The Downfall

Best for: Games where things can go catastrophically wrong

Premise:

I'm going to try to do X and watch everything fall apart

Sample intro line:

"This is either going to go perfectly or completely destroy me."

■ Package 5 The Grind Story Best for: Long progression-based simulator or RPG sessions	Premise: I'm grinding toward a specific goal and I'm not stopping until I hit it Sample intro line: <i>"The goal is simple. The execution is going to be brutal. Let's go."</i>
■ Package 6 The Experiment Best for: Testing an unconventional strategy or challenge	Premise: What happens if I try X in Y game — no one's done this before Sample intro line: <i>"Here's the question: what happens if you never upgrade anything? Let's find out."</i>
■ Package 7 The Redemption Best for: Games you've previously failed at or got destroyed by	Premise: I failed at this before, I'm coming back better Sample intro line: <i>"Last time this game beat me. Today I beat it."</i>
■ Package 8 The Commentary Run Best for: Relaxed solo sessions, talking while playing	Premise: Just playing and talking, no agenda, pure personality Sample intro line: <i>"No plan today. Just me, the game, and whatever happens."</i>

Phase 1 — Before You Record

The 5-minute pre-production that eliminates overthinking

THE GOAL

Phase 1 should take 5 minutes maximum. Answer 3 questions. Write one sentence. That's it. If you spend more than 5 minutes on this, you're overthinking it — move on.

Step 1: Pick Your Package (30 seconds)

THE QUICK DECISION TREE

Playing with Bill today? → Package 2 (Bill Chaos), almost always. | Solo session? → Ask yourself: Do I have a clear goal? (Mission) / Am I exploring something new? (Discovery) / Could things go wrong? (Downfall) / Am I grinding? (Grind Story) / Am I testing something? (Experiment) / Did I fail at this before? (Redemption) / Just want to vibe? (Commentary Run)

Step 2: Answer the 3 Questions (2 minutes)

Just finish these sentences:

PREMISE — What is this video?

"I'm trying to [do X] in [game]."

Examples: 'I'm trying to max out Pet Simulator before the event ends' / 'I'm trying to beat Doors with Bill without dying once'

PROMISE — What might happen?

"This will either [go perfectly / go terribly / be surprising / reveal something]."

Examples: 'This will either be the fastest run ever or we'll fail at the last door'

ANGLE — What's the specific flavor?

Solo / With Bill / Challenge run / Discovery / Blind playthrough / Competitive

The angle tells you how to frame the commentary during the recording.

Step 3: Write Your Intro Line (2 minutes)

One or two sentences you'll say at the very start. Use one of these as a template:

Package Type	Intro Template
Mission	"I've been putting [X] off for too long. Today we actually do it."
Bill Chaos	"Me and Bill are doing [X] today. One of us is not going to survive. (It's Bill.)"
Discovery	"I know nothing about this game. Zero. Let's change that right now."
Downfall	"This is either going to go perfectly or completely destroy me. Let's find out."
Grind Story	"The goal is [X]. I'm not stopping until I hit it."
Experiment	"Here's the question: what happens if [X]? Nobody's tested this. We're doing it."
Redemption	"Last time [game] beat me. Today I beat it."
Commentary Run	"No plan today. Just me, the game, and whatever happens."

Phase 2 — While Recording

The 3 anchors that make improv work

The 3 Recording Anchors

You don't script gameplay. But keeping these 3 concepts in the back of your mind while playing turns a gaming session into footage with a story already in it.

ANCHOR 1 — MISSION (What am I doing?)

Always know what the current goal is. Verbalize it regularly.

Instead of just playing: "Okay, the mission right now is to get past this boss without using any healing items."

The viewer stays because they know what success looks like.

ANCHOR 2 — TENSION (What could go wrong?)

Identify and narrate the stakes. What would failure look like?

"If I lose this fight, I lose 20 minutes of progress. This is the worst possible time for the game to crash."

Tension keeps people watching. No tension = no reason to stay.

ANCHOR 3 — MOMENT (Is THIS a story beat?)

Learn to recognize when something worth building around is happening.

Ask yourself in real time: "Is this a moment?" If yes — lean in. React bigger. Narrate it.

The creators who are best at this style look effortless because they've internalized this filter.

Improv Techniques That Feed the Story

Technique	How to Use It
Stakes narration	Remind the viewer what's at risk: "If this doesn't work, the whole plan falls apart"
Callbacks	Reference something from earlier: "This is exactly what happened last time with Bill"
Predictions	Say out loud what you think is about to happen — right or wrong, it's engaging
Reactions	Don't swallow genuine reactions — let them breathe, they're the whole point
Self-commentary	"Okay I have no idea what I'm doing" is more watchable than silent competence

Phase 3 — Editing the Story

How to find the story in raw footage and build it

The 4-Timestamp System

Before you start cutting anything, watch your footage and timestamp these 4 moments. Then edit toward them.

Timestamp	What to Mark	Why
BEST	The single best/funniest/most impressive moment	This is your peak — everything builds toward it
FUNNIEST	The moment that made you laugh hardest	Often becomes your thumbnail or hook moment
TENSION PEAK	The moment stakes were highest	Middle of your arc — Calm → Tension → this → Payoff
GOOD INTRO	A moment that works as an opening hook	Can reorder this to the start even if it happened later

The Story Arc

EVERY VIDEO SHOULD HIT THIS ARC AT LEAST ONCE

CALM (establish the world and goal) → TENSION (things start to go wrong or get harder) → PEAK (the highest stakes moment) → PAYOFF (the resolution — win, fail, or surprising outcome). For longer videos, aim to hit this arc 2-3 times at smaller scale before the main arc resolves.

Edit for Story, Not Chronology

- ✓ Find your BEST moment first — that's your anchor for the whole edit
- ✓ Find the SETUP for that moment — what led to it (keep this, it creates investment)
- ✓ Cut everything that doesn't serve either the best moment or its setup
- ✓ It's okay to reorder footage if it makes the story clearer
- ✓ Music sets emotional temperature — add music before SFX, it changes everything
- ✓ Text callouts should amplify the funniest lines (3-5 per video maximum)
- ✓ Build the thumbnail WHILE the video is exporting — you know the best moment now

The Flexible 8-Step Production Process

Start to upload — no rigidity, just a clear path forward

This is the full process. You don't have to follow every step perfectly — but having the sequence in your head means you always know what the next move is.

1

Idea (from your streams)

After any stream, ask: what was the funniest/most interesting/most surprising thing that happened? That's your idea. Write it in Notion Quick Capture immediately — before you forget. Ideas also come from: game autocomplete, Bill suggesting something dumb, titles you write before you even record.

2

Package + Premise (Phase 1 — 5 mins)

Pick your package. Answer Premise/Promise/Angle. Write one intro line. Do this BEFORE recording. If you can't write a title/thumbnail concept at this stage, your idea isn't ready yet.

3

Write Title + Sketch Thumbnail

Before you open the game, write at least 3 title options. Sketch (even in notes) what the thumbnail would show. This is Paddy Galloway's #1 tip — it forces clarity on what the video actually is before you waste time on footage that doesn't serve the concept.

4

Record (using the 3 Anchors)

Play with Mission, Tension, and Moment in the back of your head. Narrate stakes. React genuinely. Your Monday/Wednesday/Friday/Saturday streams are your raw footage library — flag good moments in real time with a verbal cue ('that's a clip') so you can find them later.

5

Timestamp 4 Moments Before Editing

Don't open DaVinci yet. Watch your footage first (at 1.5-2x speed). Mark: Best moment, Funniest moment, Tension peak, Good intro. Use the marker system in Resolve (M key). These 4 timestamps ARE your video structure.

6

Rough Cut First — No Polish

Pull your best clip to the start of the timeline. Build the story around how you got there. Rough cut the entire thing before adding any SFX, color grade, or text. If the rough cut is boring at this stage, restructure — don't polish a boring story.

7

Add Energy (Music, SFX, Text)

Once structure is locked: add music (emotional temperature), SFX (reactions land harder), text callouts on funniest lines (3-5 max). Your T7 SSD has: AUDIO folders (Intros/Outros/Transitions), MUSIC folders (Chill/Epic/Goofy/Happy/Horror), SFX folders (Comedy/Gaming/Horror).

8

Build Thumbnail + Upload Smart

While video exports: open Affinity Photo 2, build thumbnail (face + game moment + 2-3 bold words). Write final title from your 3 options. First line of description = game name keyword. Add VidIQ tags. Schedule for consistent upload time. Wait 24 hours after stream (Twitch exclusivity rule).

Title Formulas & Patterns

What makes people click — under 60 characters, max curiosity

The 3 Best Title Patterns for Gaming Content

PATTERN 1 — Negative Frame

Shows things going wrong — creates sympathy and morbid curiosity.

"We Got FIRED From Our Own Store (Supermarket Together)"

"This Game Completely Broke Me" / "The Worst Run I've Ever Had"

Why it works: viewers are wired to watch things go wrong before they watch things go right.

PATTERN 2 — Contrast

Two opposing forces in the same title — creates tension and irony.

"We Tried Running a Supermarket Together... It Went Horribly Wrong"

"I Tried Being Nice in This Game and Immediately Regretted It"

Why it works: contrast is inherently interesting — the brain wants to know which side wins.

PATTERN 3 — Curiosity Tease

Creates a gap between what they know and what they want to know.

"He Should NOT Be Allowed Near A Broom"

"Something Happened in This Game That Made No Sense"

Why it works: the viewer HAS to watch to close the curiosity gap.

Title Rules

- ✓ Under 60 characters — longer titles get cut off on mobile (where most views happen)
- ✓ The title sells the STORY, the thumbnail sells the GAME and EMOTION
- ✓ Don't put the game name in the title if it's in the thumbnail — save title space for the hook
- ✓ Numbers perform well: '3 Times Bill Almost Ruined Everything'
- ✓ Write 3-5 title variations before picking one — the first title is rarely the best

✓ All caps one or two words for emphasis (not the whole title)

Thumbnail Strategy — The 3 C's

Clarity · Curiosity · Contrast

The 3 C's Framework

C1 — CLARITY (Can they understand it instantly?)

Apply the Glance Test: can someone understand your thumbnail in under 1 second?

One subject, one emotion, one context. Don't overcrowd it.

If you have to explain the thumbnail, it failed.

C2 — CURIOSITY (Does it make them want to click?)

Something should be slightly unexplained — enough to trigger the click.

Your face with a reaction + a game element they don't fully understand = curiosity.

The thumbnail raises a question, the title slightly answers it (but not fully).

C3 — CONTRAST (Does it stand out in the feed?)

YouTube is a wall of competing thumbnails. Yours needs to pop.

High contrast backgrounds, bold colors, faces with extreme expressions.

Look at your game's trending videos — what do all the thumbnails look like? Be different.

Your Thumbnail Formula for Gaming Content

FACE + GAME MOMENT + 2-3 BOLD WORDS

Your facecam reaction (pull from stream footage) on the LEFT. Game screenshot or character on the RIGHT. 2-3 words of bold text that either names the situation or amplifies the emotion. Keep backgrounds simple or blurred. Expression should match the energy of the title — shock, chaos, determination, or humor.

Affinity Photo 2 Workflow Tips

- ✓ Keep a template file with your standard text styles saved (.afemplate) — reuse every time
- ✓ Use the Selection Brush to cut yourself out of facecam screenshots cleanly
- ✓ Use a Curves adjustment layer (not brightness/contrast) for consistent look

- ✓ Text should be readable at thumbnail size (tiny preview) — test by zooming out far
- ✓ 3 colors maximum — your face, the game element, and the text accent color
- ✓ Use a drop shadow on text (subtle) so it reads over any background
- ✓ Works identically on iPad, MacBook, and Windows — save your color swatches

The Hook Formula

Kallaway's 3-Step Hook — the first 30-60 seconds that make or break retention

THE HOOK IS YOUR MOST IMPORTANT PRODUCTION DECISION

More people leave in the first 30 seconds than at any other point in the video. If your hook doesn't immediately deliver on the thumbnail/title promise AND create a new reason to keep watching, you lose them. Script this part — improv the gameplay, not the intro.

Hook Structure

1

Context Lean (0-10 seconds)

Establish the world and premise in one sentence. Don't over-explain. 'I'm trying to do X in Y game' — that's enough. Match the energy of your thumbnail. If your thumbnail is chaos, open with chaos. If it's tension, open with tension.

2

Pattern Interrupt (10-25 seconds)

Break the expected flow. Show your best clip, reveal an unexpected fact, or create a question. This is what stops people from leaving. 'And halfway through, I realized this game was completely broken' — now they have to stay to find out what that means.

3

Contrarian Snapback (25-60 seconds)

Challenge what the viewer assumes about this game or situation. This creates a second hook that works as a re-engagement beat. 'But here's the thing everyone gets wrong about this — and I almost made the same mistake.' Now they need to stay to get the insight.

Re-Hook Lines

Beyond the opening, you need re-hook moments roughly every 3 minutes. These don't need to be as elaborate as the intro hook — they just need to remind the viewer why they're still watching:

- ✓ "Okay, this is where it actually gets crazy" — raises stakes, signals escalation
- ✓ "I didn't expect this to happen" — creates curiosity about what's coming
- ✓ "If you've been here from the start, you know why this matters" — rewards loyal viewers
- ✓ "Wait. Hold on." — then pause — one of the most effective retention spikes in gaming content
- ✓ "This is the moment everything either works or falls apart" — pure tension, zero cost

Edit Tab Workflow for Gaming Videos

Fast editing strategy — Edit tab for everything, minimal tab-switching

YOUR PHILOSOPHY: EDIT TAB FOR EVERYTHING

Unless you specifically need color grading (Color tab) or audio repair (Fairlight tab), stay in the Edit tab. Tab-switching breaks flow and slows you down. The Edit tab has everything you need for 95% of a gaming video: cuts, transitions, text, basic audio adjustments, and effects.

Fast Editing Workflow

1

Timeline Setup

Create your main video timeline first. Resolution: 1920x1080 (or 3840x2160 if recording 4K). Frame rate: 60fps for gaming. Your T7 SSD should already be plugged in and the Resolve_Shared disk database active before opening any project.

2

Import & Organize

Import footage from your T7 SSD. Create bins: Gameplay Footage, Facecam, Audio, Sound Effects, Music, Titles. Pull from YT_Asset_Library on the T7 for pre-organized sounds and music (MUSIC: Chill/Epic/Goofy/Happy/Horror).

3

Rough Cut Pass

Watch footage at 1.5-2x speed. Place your best moment at the head of the timeline. Use the blade tool (B) or Ctrl+B to make cuts. Don't worry about polish yet — just get the story structure right in this pass.

4

Reaction/Facecam Sync

Sync your facecam track to the gameplay audio using the automatic sync tool (right-click → Auto Align Clips). Keep facecam on a separate track above gameplay so you can adjust its position and size independently.

5

Add Text + SFX

Add Text+ elements for callouts (keep to 3-5 max per video). Add SFX from your T7 SFX folder. If Text+ is cropped: go to Layout tab in Inspector and reduce the Size value. Use your T7 Subtitles.drb power bin for the TikTok Text bounce subtitle style.

6

Color Grade (Color Tab)

After the cut is locked, switch to Color tab. Basic node setup: Correction node → Primary grade → Output node. Your color presets live in your T7 Color Correction folder. Apply, tweak, export back to Edit tab.

7

Export

Master Settings: H.264, YouTube 1080p preset, Quality: Restrict to 40,000 kbps. Audio: AAC 320kbps. If exporting for both horizontal and vertical, export horizontal first, then duplicate timeline and reframe for vertical.

Marker System & Act Labels

Single-key markers without stopping playback — your story navigation system

How to Place Markers Fast

Press M while the timeline is playing — it places a marker at the current playhead position without stopping playback. No need to pause. This lets you flag good moments in real time while watching footage.

Color Code System

Color	Meaning	When to Use
Red	Must-use / Best moment	Single best clip, peak moment, definitely in the edit
Blue	Story beat / Setup	Context moments, setup for a joke or peak, good narrative structure
Green	Shorts candidate	Standalone 30-60 second clip, funny moment, shareable
Yellow	Maybe / Review later	Decent moment, not sure yet, check this again in editing

Act Label System

Add these labels to your markers in the marker notes to track your story structure at a glance:

Label	Stands For	Use It For
CO	Cut Off / Cleanup	Dead air, waiting, off-topic tangents — delete this in edit
SETUP	Setup moment	Context that makes the peak moment land — keep it
A1	Act 1 beat	First major moment in the story arc
A2	Act 2 beat	Escalation or complication
A3	Act 3 beat	The peak / climax
X	Cut / Skip	Definitely remove this section
SHORT	Shorts candidate	Standalone clip, good for Shorts/vertical content

CLIP MARKERS vs. TIMELINE MARKERS

Clip markers (placed on a clip in the timeline) move WITH the footage when you do ripple deletes. Timeline markers (placed on the timeline ruler) stay at their time position. For story structure tracking, use clip markers. For fixed reference points (like 'add intro here'), use a second video track workaround for timeline markers.

Corsair Scimitar Mouse Mapping

12 side buttons for editing speed — your Corsair Scimitar Elite Wireless

Your Current Setup

Mouse: Corsair Scimitar Elite Wireless at 400 DPI. 12 side buttons currently mapped to top-row number keys + minus/equals in iCUE. Here's how to remap those 12 buttons specifically for editing in DaVinci Resolve:

Side Button	Recommended Action	Why
Button 1	B (Blade/Razor tool)	Most-used cut tool — one tap to slice
Button 2	A (Arrow/Selection tool)	Switch back to selection without reaching keyboard
Button 3	Ctrl+B (Split clip at playhead)	Blade at exact playhead without switching tools
Button 4	Delete / Ripple Delete (Backspace)	Remove selected clip, ripple closes gap
Button 5	M (Place marker)	Drop marker without stopping playback
Button 6	Ctrl+Z (Undo)	Closest thing to no-brainer editing insurance
Button 7	Space (Play/Pause)	Toggle playback without lifting from mouse
Button 8	Left Arrow (Frame back)	Step back one frame for precise cuts
Button 9	Right Arrow (Frame forward)	Step forward one frame for precise cuts
Button 10	Ctrl+Shift+] (Trim end to playhead)	Trim clip end to current position
Button 11	Ctrl+Shift+[(Trim start to playhead)	Trim clip start to current position
Button 12	Ctrl+D (Enable/disable clip)	Toggle clip visibility without deleting

HOW TO SET THIS UP IN iCUE

Open iCUE → Scimitar → Remap buttons to the keyboard shortcuts above. Save as a DaVinci Resolve profile. Switch to this profile when editing, back to your gaming profile when playing. This means you almost never need to touch the keyboard for basic editing operations.

Audio Levels + Export Settings

YouTube audio standards and optimal export configuration

Audio Levels for YouTube (Section 19)

YouTube normalizes audio to -14 LUFS. If your video is louder, YouTube turns it down. If it's quieter, nothing happens (it just sounds quiet to viewers).

Audio Element	Target Level	Notes
Integrated LUFS	-14 LUFS	YouTube's normalization target — aim exactly here
True Peak	-1 dBTP max	Prevents clipping on any playback system
Commentary/Voice	-12 to -10 dB	Slightly hot so it sits above music
Background Music	-20 to -18 dB	Music should be clearly under voice
SFX / Sound Effects	-12 to -8 dB	Match energy of the moment, not a fixed level
Game Audio	-18 to -16 dB	Present but not competing with voice

Quick Audio Checks

- ✓ Play back the whole video with headphones before exporting — check for any pops or clipping
- ✓ Make sure your voice is clearly audible over music at all times
- ✓ Use the Fairlight tab Loudness meter to check your integrated LUFS before export
- ✓ The De-Esser effect in Fairlight helps if your S sounds are harsh
- ✓ Add a Limiter (-1 dBTP) at the end of your master bus as insurance against peaks

Export Settings for YouTube (Section 20)

Setting	Value	Notes
Format	MP4	Most compatible with YouTube
Codec	H.264	Use H.265 only if you have a powerful enough CPU/GPU to encode it
Resolution	1920x1080 or 3840x2160	1080p for most uploads; 4K for special projects
Frame Rate	60fps	Gaming content should always be 60fps
Data Rate	40,000 kbps (1080p)	YouTube recommends 35-45 Mbps for 1080p60
Audio Codec	AAC	Standard for YouTube
Audio Bitrate	320 kbps	Highest quality YouTube accepts

Tension & Payoff Fundamentals

The secret to videos people watch until the end

THE SECRET

Every moment of your video should either be BUILDING TENSION (creating curiosity, stakes, or anticipation) or DELIVERING PAYOFF (answering questions, revealing outcomes, providing satisfaction). Most creators lose viewers in the middle because neither is happening — just gameplay happening with no stakes attached to it.

Tension vs. Payoff Balance

Think of tension and payoff like breathing in and breathing out. Too much tension with no payoff = frustrating. Too much payoff with no buildup = not satisfying. YouTube audiences need a payoff beat roughly every 30-60 seconds to stay engaged.

Type	What It Is	Gaming Examples
Micro tension	Small 30-60 second question or risk	"Will this upgrade work or waste all my coins?"
Macro tension	The main challenge of the whole video	"Can I beat the boss before the timer runs out?"
Micro payoff	Quick answer that satisfies and raises new question	"It worked! But now I realize I need three more..."
Macro payoff	The final resolution of the whole video	"We did it. After 45 minutes, we finally beat it."

Pattern and Break

THE ENGAGEMENT SPIKE TECHNIQUE

Establish a pattern (3 similar moments, explaining a system, showing a strategy working), then BREAK it with something unexpected. Our brains are wired to notice when patterns change, and that's where engagement spikes happen. For gaming: establish what 'normal' looks like in the game, then show the moment it all goes wrong.

The Opening Contract + The Story Arc

First impressions and narrative structure

Section 22: The Opening Contract

YOUR FIRST 15 SECONDS ARE A PROMISE

Your opening is a contract with the viewer about what kind of experience they're about to have. If you open with high-energy chaos but then shift into slow, methodical gameplay, you've broken that contract and people leave. Match your opening energy to your video's actual pacing. The viewer needs to know immediately what they're here to see happen.

What the Opening Contract Includes:

Element	What You're Promising
Energy level	How fast-paced and intense is this video going to be?
Tone	Is this going to be funny, intense, chill, chaotic, emotional?
Stakes	What is at risk? What's the goal? Why does it matter?
Premise	What situation are we in and where is it going?

Section 23: The Story Arc

Every compelling video — regardless of game or format — follows a version of this arc:

Stage	What Happens	Your Job As Creator
CALM	Establish the world, introduce the goal/premise	Set expectations, let viewer get oriented
TENSION	First obstacle, complication, or risk introduced	Narrate the stakes, show what could go wrong
ESCALATION	Stakes get higher, things get harder or weirder	Stay in it, keep reacting, don't bail on the tension
PEAK	The single most intense/funny/impressive moment	This should be your red-marked timestamp
PAYOFF	Resolution — win, loss, or surprising outcome	Land the story, don't drag it out after the peak

FOR LONGER VIDEOS: NESTED ARCS

A 15-minute video should contain the main arc PLUS 2-3 smaller arcs inside it. Each smaller arc follows the same structure at a compressed scale. This is what keeps 15-minute videos watchable — there are multiple moments of peak and payoff before the final resolution.

Your Content Buckets

Three pillars for your channel — every game you play fits into one of these

Your 3 Content Buckets

Your channel isn't defined by specific games — it's defined by format and energy. That's the key that stops overthinking: any game you play can fit into one of these three depending on how you angle it. You never have to say 'this game doesn't fit my channel.'

BUCKET 1 — HORROR & REACTIONS

Roblox horror, scary games, blind first playthroughs — any game where genuine fear is the product.

Hook angle: Your real reaction IS the content. Play blind. Never preview the game first.

Title formula: 'This Game [Terrified/Broke/Destroyed] Me' / 'I Finally Beat [Horror Game]'

Thumbnail: Your most terrified expression + the scariest visual from the game

Best packages: The Discovery (blind first play), The Redemption (rematching a game that beat you)

Solo or co-op: Both work — co-op adds a second layer of reaction content from your friend

BUCKET 2 — CHAOS & CO-OP

Supermarket Together, party games, any co-op game where things can go catastrophically wrong together.

Hook angle: The disaster writes itself — your job is to set up the situation and react genuinely.

Title formula: 'We Tried [X] and It Went Wrong' / 'He Should NOT Be Allowed to [Do X]'

Thumbnail: Two reaction faces + the chaotic game element — both players visible

Best packages: Bill Chaos, The Downfall, The Experiment

This is your friends bucket — the energy, not the specific friend, is what the bucket is about

BUCKET 3 — CHALLENGES & GRIND

Roblox simulators, solo challenges, competitive games — any game with a clear goal you're chasing.

Hook angle: Set an impossible-seeming target and don't stop until you hit it.

Title formula: 'I Won't Stop Until I [Max Out / Beat / Hit Level X]' / 'I Tried [Unusual Strategy] and...'

Thumbnail: Your reaction + the goal/achievement on screen (big number, unlock, final boss)

Best packages: The Grind Story, The Mission, The Experiment

FLEX BUCKET: Fortnite, Apex, Roblox, any new game — they all fit here with the right angle

WHY THIS SYSTEM WORKS

Buckets 1 and 3 are mostly solo content. Bucket 2 is your co-op/friends content. The even split you naturally have is already accounted for. No game ever feels out of place — a simulator can be Bucket 3 (challenge/grind), or it can be Bucket 2 if you play it co-op and chaos happens. The angle determines the bucket, not the game.

Game-Specific Strategies

Roblox, Horror, Fortnite, Apex, and Simulators

Roblox

- ✓ Keep 'Roblox' in the description (keyword) but test with and without it in titles
- ✓ Roblox horror games perform best as blind playthroughs — never preview the game before recording
- ✓ Simulator games: set a specific public challenge ('I won't stop until I hit level 100')
- ✓ Co-op Roblox with Bill: the chaos sells itself, just make sure the thumbnail shows two players
- ✓ Trending Roblox games: check Roblox trending page + VidIQ alerts for quick wins

Horror Games

- ✓ Play blind for the first time ON STREAM — genuine fear is the whole product
- ✓ Save horror games you haven't played yet specifically for first-time stream moments
- ✓ Reactions > strategy in horror content — don't try to speedrun or 'play well', play scared
- ✓ Title: focus on the emotion ('This Game SCARED ME') not the gameplay description
- ✓ Thumbnail: your most terrified face + the scariest visual from the game
- ✓ Horror + Bill = double content gold (his reactions add a second layer of comedy)

Fortnite & Apex Legends

- ✓ For competitive games, the storyline angle wins over 'I got kills' — 'I Tried X and It Actually Worked'
- ✓ Clutch moments and unexpected strategies perform better than highlight compilations at your stage
- ✓ Tie content to current patches or meta changes — VidIQ trending alerts will catch these
- ✓ Title formula: 'I Won Using Only [Unusual Strategy]' or 'The [Item] Everyone Ignored Is Actually Broken'

Simulators

- ✓ Best hook: set a challenge with a time limit or impossible-seeming goal
- ✓ Give your chat a goal during the stream: 'we're not stopping until I hatch a legendary'
- ✓ Simulator content works great as long videos (15-20 min) because the progression IS the story
- ✓ Milestone moments (leveling up, big unlocks, expensive purchases) = natural payoff beats

Co-op & Friends Content

How to record with other people and make the chaos actually watchable

Why Co-op Content Works So Well

THE CO-OP ADVANTAGE

When you play with a friend, you stop being the only source of energy in the video. Their decisions, their reactions, their mistakes — all of it creates content you couldn't manufacture alone. Your job shifts from 'be interesting' to 'react to interesting things happening around you.' That's a way easier job.

The Dynamic That Makes It Work

The most watchable co-op gaming content has a clear dynamic between the players. You don't need to script it — but you do need to be aware of it:

Role	What They Do	Why Viewers Love It
The Reactor	Responds to chaos, calls out what's happening, is the audience stand-in	Viewers see themselves in this role — relatable
The Chaos Agent	Makes unpredictable decisions, does the wrong thing, creates the disaster	Unpredictable = can't look away
The Straight Man	Keeps trying to do it correctly while chaos happens around them	The contrast between order and chaos is inherently funny

You don't have to assign roles deliberately — just be aware of what's naturally happening. If your friend is being chaotic, lean into being the reactor. If you're both chaotic, someone needs to occasionally be the voice of 'okay but we actually need to do this' for contrast.

What to Actually Do During Co-op Recording

- ✓ Set a clear shared goal before starting — both players should know what success looks like
- ✓ Don't over-explain the plan; confusion between players creates organic funny moments
- ✓ React out loud to what your friend does — don't let their chaos happen silently
- ✓ Call out stakes regularly: 'if we fail this we lose everything we just did'
- ✓ Let your friend make their own decisions — don't micromanage, the wrong choice IS the content
- ✓ Play games with meaningful consequences for failure — stakes make chaos matter
- ✓ If something funny happens, say so in the moment — don't rely on the edit to explain it
- ✓ Callbacks: reference earlier moments out loud ('this is exactly what happened last time')

Packaging Co-op Videos

- ✓ Title: make the situation (or your friend) the subject — 'We Got Fired' not 'We Played Together'
- ✓ Thumbnail: show both players when possible — two faces = more emotional information in one image
- ✓ The title sells the DISASTER, the thumbnail sells the REACTION to the disaster
- ✓ Avoid titles that require the viewer to know your friend — 'He Did Something Terrible' > '[Name] Did Something Terrible'
- ✓ The chaos should be self-explanatory to someone who has never watched your channel before

Best Games for Co-op Content

Game Type	Why It Works for Co-op
Co-op survival/jobs (Supermarket Together, etc.)	Individual tasks with shared failure — one person ruins it for both
Roblox horror co-op	Fear + another person reacting to fear = double the content
Party games	Short rounds, rapid chaos, easy to edit into punchy moments
Any game with a traitor/imposter mechanic	Built-in betrayal arc — guaranteed story every session
Competitive games (1v1 or same team)	Stakes are personal, trash talk is natural, outcomes hit harder

Streaming → YouTube Pipeline

From stream to upload — your full content production loop

The 24-Hour Exclusivity Rule

TWITCH AFFILIATE RULE

As a Twitch Affiliate, your streams should have 24-hour exclusivity on Twitch before the VOD or any clips appear on YouTube. Respect this. Beyond the rule, it also creates demand — your Twitch audience knows the full stream was there first, and your YouTube audience gets a curated, edited version with a clear reason to watch.

Your Streaming Schedule as a Content System

Your streams (Monday, Wednesday, Friday, Saturday at 7PM PST) are your raw footage library. Every stream can become 1-3 YouTube videos. Here's how to think about it:

Stream Type	YouTube Potential
Horror game (new/blind)	1 long video (full first playthrough) + 2-3 reaction clip Shorts
Co-op with Bill	1-2 videos (best Bill Chaos moments edited into narrative) + clips
Simulator/grind session	1 long video (grind challenge) + 1 milestone Short
Competitive game (Apex/Fortnite)	1 video (best strategy/clutch moment + context) + clips

Clip Flagging During Streams

- ✓ Say 'that's a clip' or 'timestamp that' out loud during the stream — creates a searchable reference
- ✓ Keep Notion Quick Capture open on your phone or iPad during streams for instant idea capture
- ✓ After the stream ends, immediately write down the 2-3 best moments while they're fresh
- ✓ Don't rely on VOD review alone — the hot take you have right after stream is usually right

Notion Content HQ

Your production command center — structure and how to use it

Your Notion Content HQ Structure

Section	What Lives There
Quick Capture / Idea Inbox	Raw ideas, stream moments, anything you want to capture fast — no formatting required
Brainstorm & Ideas Bank	Developed ideas with title options, game, package type, premise
Stream Planning	Upcoming stream games, goals, Bill availability, chat engagement plans
YouTube Video Tracker (database)	Every video: status (Idea/Recording/Editing/Uploaded), upload date, CTR, AVD notes
Video Production Hub	Active videos in progress, master VIDEO TEMPLATE, Completed Archive, Scrapped Ideas

The Master VIDEO TEMPLATE

For each video you start, fill out this template in Notion. It's not a cage — it's a map. You don't have to follow it exactly. But filling it out clarifies your thinking before you hit record:

✓	Package (which of the 8 templates?)
✓	Premise (I'm trying to X in Y game)
✓	Promise (this will either...)
✓	Angle (solo / Bill / challenge / discovery)
✓	One intro line (written out)
✓	Title options (write 3 at minimum)
✓	Thumbnail concept (describe it in one sentence)
✓	Status (Idea / Recording / Editing / Ready to Upload / Live)

FLEXIBILITY IS THE POINT

The Notion template is a thinking tool, not a checklist you must complete. If you have a strong idea and you know what you're doing, record immediately and fill in the template after. The goal is to never feel paralyzed — the system serves the video, not the other way around.

Batch Filming & Editing

The most efficient way to produce consistent content without burning out

THE PROBLEM WITH EPISODE-BY-EPISODE PRODUCTION

Film one video → edit it → upload → film next video → edit it → upload. This cycle creates friction at every step and makes YouTube feel like a constant grind. Batching breaks the cycle — your brain stays in 'recording mode' for a session, then stays in 'editing mode' for a session.

Batch Filming Strategy

1

Record 3-4 Sessions in One Block

Dedicate one day or long session to recording only. Record 3-4 gaming sessions back to back. Use your Mon-Wed-Fri-Sat streams as the primary source, or schedule dedicated recording sessions on off days if you want extra content.

2

Flag Clips in Real Time

During each session, say 'clip that' for moments you want to use. Or use Resolve markers if recording directly to project. Don't try to edit during recording — just flag and keep going.

3

Process the Batch Later

In a separate editing session (next day or dedicated editing block), go through all the flagged material from the batch. Your ideas will be fresher than if you tried to edit immediately after recording.

4

Edit All at Once

Rough cut all 3-4 videos in one editing session before polishing any of them. Then polish one at a time. This batching approach keeps you in creative flow and prevents the 'just finished editing, don't want to touch Resolve for a week' burnout.

5

Schedule Uploads in Advance

Once you have 2-3 videos edited, schedule them in YouTube Studio for your consistent upload day/time. This creates breathing room — you're never scrambling to upload the night before.

Short Form Content

Shorts strategy, clip identification, packaging, and how it feeds your long form channel

Why Shorts Matter For Your Channel

SHORTS ARE YOUR DISCOVERY ENGINE

Long form videos grow your existing audience. Shorts grow your total reach. A Short that pops on someone's feed introduces you to a viewer who may never have searched for your channel. Think of Shorts as trailers for your personality — the job isn't to be a complete video, it's to make someone curious enough to click your channel page.

How Shorts Feed Long Form

Shorts Do This...	Which Means...
Expose you to new viewers through the Shorts feed	Higher subscriber growth independent of search traffic
Act as a preview of your content style/energy	People who subscribe from a Short already know what to expect
Clip your best long form moments	They also drive traffic back to the full video if linked
Keep your channel active between uploads	The algorithm sees consistent activity even during editing weeks
Cost almost zero extra time if pulled from stream footage	High output, low additional effort

How to Identify Shorts From Stream Footage

A Short candidate from your stream footage needs to pass the 60-second self-contained test:

THE SELF-CONTAINED TEST

Watch the clip with the sound off. Does something visually interesting happen? Now watch it with sound. Does it have a clear beginning (setup), middle (tension or action), and end (reaction or punchline) within 60 seconds? If yes — it's a Short. If it needs 30 seconds of context to make sense → it's a teaser Short or a highlight from a long form video (link the full video in comments).

Short Clip Signals — What to Look For

- ✓ A genuine reaction moment — jump scare, burst of laughter, visible frustration, genuine shock
- ✓ A friend (Bill) doing something obviously wrong with your reaction right after — complete arc in under 30 seconds

- ✓ A clutch moment — last-second save, impossible shot, narrowly surviving something
- ✓ A single joke or in-game event that lands hard and needs no setup
- ✓ A 'wait, what?' moment — something visually weird or unexpected that makes someone stop scrolling
- ✓ A fail with a strong reaction — the fail IS the punchline, no setup required
- ✓ A transformation — character/level/stats before and after (works especially well for simulator content)

Short Form Structure

Shorts are NOT miniature long form videos. The structure is completely different:

Part	Long Form	Short Form
Hook	First 30-60 seconds — build context, create question	First 1-3 SECONDS — if they're not hooked, they swipe
Middle	Multiple re-engagement beats, story arc, escalation	One beat — the tension or buildup (keep it tight)
End	Payoff + resolution + call to action	Punchline or reaction — that's it, no fluff after
Re-hooks	Every 3 minutes	None — the whole Short IS the hook
CTA	Subscribe, comment, watch next video	One thing only: 'watch the full video' or 'follow'

THE PUNCHLINE RULE

End on the reaction, not after it. The moment your reaction to the funny/scary/impressive thing finishes — cut. Don't add 5 seconds of you saying 'anyway subscribe.' The punchline is the last thing they should see. Anything after the punchline loses views.

Short Form Packaging

Shorts have different packaging rules than long form. Thumbnails barely matter (most people see Shorts in the feed without clicking a thumbnail), but the first frame and the title still do:

- ✓ **FIRST FRAME:** the most visually interesting or emotional frame from the clip — this is what shows in the Shorts feed before autoplay starts
- ✓ **TITLE:** shorter than long form — under 40 characters. State the situation bluntly. 'He Ruined The Whole Store.' 'I Did NOT Expect This.' 'The Jump Scare Got Me.'
- ✓ **NO CLICKBAIT:** Shorts viewers swipe fast — if the video doesn't match the title in the first 2 seconds, they're gone and that tanks your retention metric
- ✓ **HASHTAGS:** add #Shorts to the description — YouTube needs this signal to distribute in the Shorts feed
- ✓ **CAPTIONS:** add auto-captions or manual subtitles — a huge percentage of Shorts are watched muted
- ✓ **VERTICAL FORMAT:** 9:16 ratio, 1080x1920px — your Aitum Suite setup already outputs vertical via OBS

Your Aitum Suite Vertical Workflow

YOU'RE ALREADY SET UP FOR THIS

Your OBS + Aitum Suite setup streams simultaneously in horizontal (16:9) and vertical (9:16). This means every stream already produces vertical footage. For Shorts from streams: your vertical OBS output is already cropped and formatted — just clip it, trim it to under 60 seconds in DaVinci, add captions, and upload. Zero extra setup required.

Shorts Workflow From Stream

1

Flag During Stream

When something clipworthy happens, say 'Short that' or drop a GREEN marker in Resolve. Green = Shorts candidate in your marker color system.

2

Pull From Vertical Output

Use the vertical OBS recording (already formatted 9:16 from Aitum). No reframing needed — it's already cropped correctly.

3

Edit in DaVinci (Under 5 Minutes)

Import vertical clip. Trim start and end tight. Add auto-captions (Subtitles.drb power bin from your T7). Add one SFX if needed. Done.

4

Upload Separately (Not as YouTube Short of Long Form)

Upload Shorts as their own uploads, not as clips of existing videos. Separate uploads get separate algorithmic pushes. Link to the full video in the description if relevant.

5

Wait 24 Hours After Stream

Same Twitch exclusivity rule applies — don't post the Short until 24h after the stream it came from.

How Many Shorts Per Long Form Video?

Long Form Template	Typical Shorts Potential
B — The First Timer (horror/new game)	3-5 Shorts — every major scare or discovery moment
F — The Co-op Disaster	2-4 Shorts — each major friend fail is its own Short
D — The Time Limit	1-2 Shorts — the final countdown + the outcome
A — The Impossible Challenge	1-2 Shorts — the closest call and the resolution
J — The Challenge Bet	1 Short — the loser's reaction moment
I — The Rating Run	1 Short — your reaction to the worst or best entry

Pre-Video Checklist

Section 31 — Before you hit record

- ✓ Chose a video package from the 8 templates
- ✓ Answered the 3 questions: Premise / Promise / Angle
- ✓ Wrote one intro line
- ✓ Wrote at least 3 title options
- ✓ Sketched or described the thumbnail concept
- ✓ Started a Notion video entry (even if just title + package)
- ✓ Confirmed if Bill is involved — coordinated session time
- ✓ Checked if this game is currently trending (VidIQ or YouTube search)
- ✓ Stream VOD exclusivity window is over (24h since stream if applicable)
- ✓ T7 SSD plugged in before opening Resolve if you're recording directly to project

· SECTION 32

Recording Checklist

- ✓ OBS is set up and test recording is clean (gameplay + facecam + audio all synced)
- ✓ Audio levels checked — voice is clear and not clipping
- ✓ Game settings noted if relevant (character, mode, any specific run parameters)
- ✓ Intro line is ready in your head — say it naturally, don't read it
- ✓ 3 anchors in mind: Mission / Tension / Moment
- ✓ Ready to narrate stakes out loud during gameplay
- ✓ Ready to react genuinely — don't suppress reactions
- ✓ Notion open on secondary device for quick clip flagging or idea capture
- ✓ If with Bill: game goal communicated to him before starting

Editing Checklist

- ✓ T7 SSD plugged in, Resolve_Shared disk database active before opening project
- ✓ Footage imported and organized into bins (Gameplay / Facecam / Audio / SFX / Music)
- ✓ Watched footage at 1.5-2x speed and marked 4 timestamps: Best / Funniest / Tension peak / Good intro
- ✓ Used marker color codes (Red=best, Blue=story beat, Green=Shorts, Yellow=maybe)
- ✓ Best clip pulled to the head of the timeline first
- ✓ Rough cut complete before any polish (story structure locked)
- ✓ Facecam synced to gameplay audio
- ✓ Boring sections removed — CO-marked clips cut
- ✓ Re-engagement check: is there a beat every ~3 minutes?
- ✓ Music added (from T7 MUSIC folder — Chill/Epic/Goofy/Happy/Horror)
- ✓ SFX added (from T7 SFX folder — Comedy/Gaming/Horror)
- ✓ Text callouts added (3-5 max per video, Text+ in Resolve)
- ✓ Audio levels balanced: voice -12 to -10 dB, music -20 to -18 dB, game audio -18 to -16 dB
- ✓ Integrated LUFS checked in Fairlight (target: -14 LUFS)
- ✓ Color grade applied (Color tab, from T7 Color Correction presets)
- ✓ Final playback watch (full video with headphones) before export
- ✓ Export settings: H.264, 1920x1080 or 4K, 60fps, 40,000 kbps, AAC 320kbps

Upload Checklist

- ✓ Thumbnail built in Affinity Photo 2 (face + game moment + 2-3 bold words)
- ✓ 3 C's verified: Clarity (glance test) / Curiosity (raises a question) / Contrast (pops in feed)
- ✓ Final title selected from your 3+ options (under 60 characters)
- ✓ Story lock verified: title and thumbnail tell the same story from different angles
- ✓ Description first line: includes game name keyword naturally
- ✓ Description has timestamps if video is 10+ minutes
- ✓ Relevant hashtags added (#Roblox, #Fortnite, #ApexLegends, etc.)

- ✓ VidIQ tags added (include game name, game + content type, specific topic keywords)
- ✓ Scheduled for your consistent upload time (not dropped randomly)
- ✓ Video set to appropriate age restriction settings (your audience is 13-18)
- ✓ End screen and cards added (link to relevant previous video)
- ✓ Pinned comment ready to post immediately after going live

48-Hour Post-Upload Check

Run this check 24-48 hours after every upload. This is how you get better at a rate faster than just grinding videos.

- ✓ Open YouTube Studio → Check CTR (target 8-12%+ for gaming)
- ✓ Check AVD (target 40-50%+ of total video length)
- ✓ Read the retention graph — where is the biggest drop?
- ✓ If CTR < 5%: packaging problem → consider thumbnail/title swap
- ✓ If CTR strong but AVD low: hook or intro problem → fix the first 60 seconds next time
- ✓ If both low: concept problem → start with a better idea next video
- ✓ Reply to every comment in the first 24-48 hours (boosts satisfaction signals)
- ✓ Note one specific thing to do better in your next video (write it in Notion)
- ✓ If CTR is exceptionally strong: note exactly what made the packaging work — replicate it
- ✓ Check which traffic source brought the most views (search vs. browse vs. suggested)

FINAL WORD

The system only works if you actually use it. Pick one video. Fill in the template. Record it. Edit it. Upload it. That first video teaches you more than all of this theory combined. Everything in this document is designed to make your first (and 50th) video easier to execute — but the reps are irreplaceable. Now go make something.

One video at a time. One small improvement at a time. ■